

Simple Hulk - RULES



Corridors. Contacts. Overwatch.

A two-player boarding game of narrow corridors, hidden bugs, and desperate reaction fire. One player commands five Marines; the other commands the aliens. Expect 75-120 minutes. This book has a cover and six rules pages. The companion FLUFF book contains optional rules and eight further scenarios. Use the core rules for your first expedition; add variants after a rematch.

Rules page 1 of 6 - Get aboard

What you need

- Two ordinary six-sided dice (d6), paper, pencil, and a square grid.
- Five Marine counters with arrows showing their facing.
- Alien counters, blip counters, door counters, and overwatch/jam markers.
- A roster to record wounds, ammunition, and hidden blip strengths.

One square holds one model or one blip. Walls are impassable. Models cannot move through each other. All distances count squares; movement is orthogonal, never diagonal. No measuring tape or miniatures are needed.

Your boarding team

Each Marine has **4 action points (AP)** per round, **2 wounds**, and one assigned weapon. Use two boarding rifles, one scattergun, one rotary cannon, and one flame projector for your first game. Every Marine also has a knife and two grenades: one fragmentation and one stun. Grenades occupy no hand slots. Marines keep facing; aliens do not.

A basic alien has **6 AP**, **1 wound**, and claws. Each alien activates once per round. An alien created by revealing a blip inherits its remaining AP instead of receiving fresh AP. Wounds persist. Remove a model immediately at zero wounds.

Round sequence

1. **Marine phase:** Clear all overwatch markers. Each surviving Marine activates once, in any order, spending up to 4 AP before the next Marine activates.
2. **Alien phase:** Receive mission reinforcements, then activate every alien and blip once, in any order. Finish one activation before starting another.
3. **End phase:** Remove stun markers, advance the round counter, and check the mission deadline. Overwatch remains set until the next Marine phase.

Unused AP disappear. You may stop an activation early. There are no shared action points, free actions, or actions during another model's activation except the specified overwatch reactions. The Marines take the first phase of round 1.

Dice and damage

A ranged attack rolls the number of dice listed for its weapon. Each die meeting its hit number inflicts one wound on its target. Excess wounds are lost. Unless an attack explicitly affects an area, it has just one target. There are no armor saves. Roll melee as described on rules page 2.

First game: Build the rules page 6 map, place the five Marines on M squares facing north, and give the alien player four starting blips. Read rules pages 2-5, then begin.

Rules page 2 of 6 - Movement, sight, and claws

Actions

Action	Marine AP	Alien/blip AP
Move one square forward or sideways, keeping facing	1	1
Move one square backward, keeping facing	2	1
Turn 90 degrees	1	Not needed
Open or close an adjacent door	1	1
Make one ranged attack	Weapon cost	-
Make one melee attack against an adjacent enemy	1	1
Throw a grenade	2	-
Enter overwatch	2	-
Clear a jam	1	-
Operate a mission console while standing on it	2	-

An about-face takes two turns. All adjacency means orthogonal adjacency. You can open or close a door from any square next to it, regardless of facing. An open door is an ordinary floor square. A door cannot close while its square is occupied. Closed doors block movement and sight. Doors cannot be attacked in the basic rules.

Facing and line of sight

A Marine can shoot or throw into its **front arc**: the forward half of the board, including its sideways boundary. A target directly behind or behind-and-sideways is outside that arc. For example, a north-facing Marine can target any square in its own row or farther north, subject to range and clear sight.

Range is **Manhattan distance**: horizontal squares plus vertical squares between shooter and target. Adjacent targets are range 1; the shooter's own square is 0. Draw a straight line between square centers. Any intervening wall, closed door, model, or blip blocks that line. If the line touches a wall corner, sight is blocked; no shooting diagonally through a doorway's corner. If uncertain, treat sight as blocked and use the same interpretation for both teams.

Marines see in **all directions**, with unlimited sight range, using those same blocking rules. Facing limits shooting and throwing, not detection. Check blip visibility after every action, including Marine movement and door opening.

Melee

An attacker must be a model, not a blip. It attacks an orthogonally adjacent enemy; Marines may attack in any direction. Both models roll one d6. A Marine adds **+0**; a basic alien adds **+2**. A rear attack gives the alien another **+1** if it occupies the square directly behind the Marine.

The higher total inflicts one wound on the loser. A tie does nothing. The defender may wound the attacker even though it is not activating. Each attack costs 1 AP, so a surviving attacker can fight again. Neither model moves after a fight.

Rules page 3 of 6 - Overwatch: hold that corridor

Overwatch is the core rule. It exchanges movement and initiative for repeated reaction shots. A Marine pays **2 AP** to enter overwatch with an eligible, unjammed weapon. Mark it immediately. Entering overwatch ends that Marine's activation, even if it has AP left. It cannot turn or perform other actions while marked. Reactions cost no AP and have no per-round limit, but ammunition still applies.

Exactly when a reaction happens

During the alien phase, resolve each alien/blip action in this order:

1. Spend AP and finish movement, a door action, or another non-attack action. If it is a melee attack, spend its AP but **pause before rolling melee**.
2. Reveal newly visible blips using rules page 5.
3. Every overwatching Marine that can shoot the **acting alien** may fire once. Resolve eligible Marines in the Marine player's chosen order.
4. If the acting alien survives, finish its paused melee attack, if any. Continue its activation if it has AP left.

The target must be in range, in the Marine's front arc, and have clear line of sight. No reaction occurs merely because a phase begins, a model stands still, or reinforcements arrive. Spending AP to do nothing does not trigger a reaction. An alien moving into an adjacent square can be shot before it spends a later AP to attack. Declaring an attack while already adjacent also triggers a shot before melee. A door-opening alien can be shot through the newly open doorway.

If the acting blip reveals, nominate one of its placed aliens as the **acting alien** before any reaction. Other aliens placed by that reveal do not generate shots just for appearing. They will generate reactions when they act. A Marine may decline any reaction. If an earlier shot kills the acting alien, later Marines cannot shoot a replacement target during that same reaction window.

Jams

For each overwatch attack, roll the weapon's normal dice. **If any die is a 1, the weapon jams and the entire attack inflicts no damage.** Mark the jam and remove that Marine's overwatch marker. Ordinary shots never jam. An empty weapon cannot fire or enter overwatch.

A jammed Marine cannot shoot or enter overwatch until it spends 1 AP clearing the jam during its next activation. Clearing costs no ammunition. Jams do not prevent movement, melee, grenades, or console use. A jam does not change melee rolls.

Example: three chances, one failure

An alien moves into a rifle's range and rolls no dice itself. The Marine reacts, rolling 2 and 4: a miss. The alien moves again; the reaction rolls 3 and 5, killing it. A second alien opens a door and draws another reaction: 1 and 6. That shot deals no damage and jams the rifle. The second alien can advance safely from that Marine until the gun is cleared and overwatch is set again.

Rules page 4 of 6 - Four weapons, two grenades

Assign each Marine one weapon for the whole mission. All weapons have unlimited ammunition except the rotary cannon and flame projector. Weapons cannot be transferred. Ammunition is per attack, including failed or jammed attacks.

Weapon	Attack AP	Range	Dice / hit	Overwatch?	Melee bonus
Boarding rifle	1	8	2d6 / 5+	Yes	+0
Scattergun	1	4	3d6 / 5+	Yes	+0
Rotary cannon	1	10	3d6 / 5+	Yes	+0
Flame projector	2	4	Special below	No	+0

Boarding rifle: Reliable reach with no additional rules.

Scattergun: At range 1-2, hits on 4+ instead of 5+. It still targets just one alien; other models block its shot normally.

Rotary cannon: Starts with **8 ammunition marks**. Cross off one whenever an attack is rolled. No reloads in the basic game. A jam on its last ammunition mark leaves it empty.

Flame projector: Starts with **4 fuel marks**; each attack spends one. Choose a visible floor square in the front arc within range. Roll one d6 for each model on that square and each orthogonally adjacent floor square: on 3+, that model suffers **2 wounds**. Walls and closed doors exclude their own squares; the blast never crosses a closed door or wall to affect a neighboring square. Friendly models can be hit. There is no lingering fire. Reveal blips in the area before rolling; roll separately for every alien placed in affected squares. Aliens placed outside the affected squares are not hit.

Grenades

Each Marine starts with **one of each**. Cross off a grenade when thrown. Choose a visible floor square in its front arc at range 1-4. Grenades automatically land there; they cannot bounce around corners. Their affected area is the target and its orthogonally adjacent floor squares, with the flame projector's wall/door restriction. Reveal affected blips before applying effects. No overwatch occurs in the Marine phase.

- **Fragmentation:** Roll one d6 per affected model. On 4+, inflict one wound. Friendly models can be wounded.
- **Stun:** Every affected model loses **2 AP during the upcoming alien phase** (minimum 0). Mark affected models; repeated stuns do not stack. Stunned aliens still defend in melee. A stunned Marine loses its overwatch marker immediately and cannot enter overwatch again this round. It keeps any remaining Marine AP.

If a stunned blip is revealed later, all its aliens inherit the stun. At the end of the alien phase, remove all stun markers, even from models that never acted.

Rules page 5 of 6 - Blips and alien deployment

Hidden contacts

Make numbered blips and privately assign each a strength of **1, 2, or 3 aliens**. Use the mission's blip pool. For the starting mission, prepare twelve numbered blips: four strength-1, four strength-2, and four strength-3. Shuffle their assignment, record it secretly, and use each blip once. The Marine player sees only its number. Blips have 6 AP, move without facing, operate doors, and block sight like models. They cannot attack or occupy an objective to deny console use unless they physically block the square.

A blip must reveal as soon as any Marine has line of sight to it. The alien player may also reveal one voluntarily at the start of that blip's activation, for no AP. Reveal before trying to attack or before ending movement next to a Marine. There are no empty blips in the basic game.

Place the aliens

Remove the blip. Place the first alien on its square, then place the others on empty orthogonally adjacent floor squares. Choose their positions, but do not place through closed doors. If there is insufficient room, excess aliens are lost. They cannot be held in reserve or placed farther away.

If the blip had not activated this phase, each revealed alien may activate later this phase with its normal 6 AP. If it reveals during its activation, pick one alien to continue immediately; **all** its aliens have only the blip's remaining AP and the others activate later. If the blip had finished its activation, all its aliens count as activated and wait until next round. Stun reduces the blip's budget once; do not subtract it again from inherited remaining AP.

For a grenade or flame attack, placement happens before damage and follows these same constraints. Models created during the Marine phase get their normal alien phase activation, subject to stun. A blip directly visible to a Marine reveals before it can be chosen as an ordinary ranged target.

Starting blips and reinforcements

Follow the mission's starting contacts, arrival phases, and entry limits. A new blip must use an empty entry square. If no legal entry is free, queue the arrival until the next alien phase; place queued blips oldest first, within the mission's per-phase arrival cap. New scheduled arrivals join the queue behind waiting ones. Unused contacts expire after the mission's last permitted arrival phase.

An arrival in Marine sight reveals immediately but causes no overwatch shot until an alien acts. Starting contacts also reveal if visible. There are no other aliens or replenishment unless a mission says otherwise. Reveal the roster after play. All core aliens use the basic profile; optional types are in FLUFF.

Quick reference

Marines: 4 AP, 2 wounds. Aliens: 6 AP, 1 wound, melee +2. Move 1, door 1, melee 1; Marine backward movement 2, turn 1, clear jam 1, grenade 2, console 2. Overwatch costs 2 AP and ends activation. React after movement or door actions, before attacks. Any reaction die of 1 cancels damage and jams the weapon. Revealed aliens inherit remaining blip AP when revealed during an activation.

Rules page 6 of 6 - Mission: Wake the beacon

Restore both relays, then transmit from the beacon. North is up. Each character is one square: . floor, = closed door, M Marine start, A-F alien entries, U/V relays, X beacon. |, -, and + outline hull walls and their corners; blank cells are inaccessible space outside the passages. Walls and blanks block movement and sight. Labels are floor; all seven doors start closed. The two digit rows number columns; omitted trailing cells are blank.

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00000000011111111122222222233
1234567890123456789012345678901
1  +-+ +-+ +-+ +-+ +-+
2  ++.++ |.| |X| |.| ++.++
3  ++...+--+ +---+ +---+ +---+...++
4  |A.U.....V.B|
5  ++...+--+ +---+ +---+ +---+...++
6  ++.++ |.| |.| |.| ++.++
7  |=| |.| |.| |.| |=|
8  |.| ++.++ |.| |.| |.|
9  +-+.+---+...+---+ +---+ +---+ +---+
10 |F.....=.....E|
11 +-+.+---+...+---+ +---+ +---+ +---+
12 |.| ++.++ |.| |.| |.|
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15 +-+.+---+ +---+ +---+ +---+...+---+ +---+
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18 |.| |.| |.| ++.++ |.|
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21 +-+.+---+ ++.....++ +---+ +---+
22 |.....|
23 +-+.+---+ ++.MMMM.++ +---+ +---+
24 +-+ +-+-----+---+ +-+
25
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Setup and reinforcements

Place rifle, scattergun, cannon, flame projector, rifle on the five M squares, left to right, facing north. All start fully supplied. Place four shuffled blips on A, B, C, D. The twelve-blip pool is on rules page 5. Schedule two more blips at each alien phase 2-5, using distinct empty entries A-F. The arrival cap is two per phase, including queued contacts; discard the queue after phase 10.

Objectives and deadline

A Marine standing on U or V spends 2 AP to restore that relay; mark it permanently. After both are restored, a Marine on X spends 2 AP to transmit: immediate Marine victory. Aliens win if all Marines die or transmission is unfinished at the end of Marine phase **12**. Do not play alien phase 12 if the deadline ends the game.

Example of a plan

The squad starts in the south chamber at row 23, columns 14-18. Split toward the west and east relays at (4,4) and (4,28), while one rifle covers the central route to X at (2,16). Every console costs 2 AP; reaching one with 1 AP left means waiting. Opening the door at (19,16) costs 1 AP and can reveal contacts farther north. The board has loops, so a held corridor does not seal every approach. All starts and entries connect to all objectives through operable doors. Optional tile patterns, bug types, and eight detailed missions are in FLUFF.md.